One of the indicators of Stark's elaborate taste was the estate's grand living-room space (below), ostentatiously thrust out over the water and held in place by a series of buttresses that were set atop the ocean exposure of the Workshop below. The placement of Stark's garage underneath the living room ended up being Phil Saunders' sole contribution to the space that would later be referred to as the Workshop.

This economically staged area would provide for one of the film's most comedic story beats: Following the maiden voyage of the Mark II suit, Tony Stark's attempt to land his formidably heavy armor on the roof causes him to crash through the floor of his living room and onto the hood of a prized automobile in the Workshop. Without the intense planning put into this set design, that beat would not have been inspired.

